

Sushant Gautam | Postdoctoral Fellow — AI Safety

☎ +47 986 72 556 • ✉ sushant@simula.no • 🌐 sushant.no • in eSushant
🔗 SushantGautam • 📄 Sushant-Gautam • 🏠 t3lie8cAAAAJ

Work Experience

Simula Metropolitan Center for Digital Engineering (SimulaMet) **Oslo, Norway**
Postdoctoral Fellow (Full-time), Department of AI Safety *Aug 2026 – Present*
Research on **AI safety**, building on doctoral work in multimodal learning for robust and trustworthy AI models.

Simula Metropolitan Center for Digital Engineering (SimulaMet) **Oslo, Norway**
Ph.D. Student, Affiliated with Oslo Metropolitan University *May 2023 – Jul 2026*
Conducted research on **multimodal learning for robust and trustworthy vision–language models**; supervised master's students in AI and medical imaging; represented Simula at the NORA Student Council and organized academic and outreach events; participated in Simula Academy outreach programs to inspire and attract master's students to research.

The Alan Turing Institute **London, United Kingdom**
Ph.D. Enrichment Student for the Turing Enrichment Scheme 2024/25 *Oct 2024 – Jul 2025*
Selected through the Norwegian Artificial Intelligence Research Consortium (NORA); undertook a six-month research stay in London as part of doctoral training; served as Student Representative for the cohort; contributed to discussions that led to the extension of Kvasir-VQA into a multi-task and a multi-complexity benchmark for medical reasoning in gastrointestinal endoscopy; participated in Turing–Roche Co-working sessions, AI-UK 2025 volunteering, and professional development workshops; fostered interdisciplinary collaborations across UK research labs and universities.

Thapathali Campus, Tribhuvan University **Kathmandu, Nepal**
Adjunct Lecturer (Contract-based) *Oct 2022 – May 2023*
○ Lectures and labs for "A Practical Approach to Deep Learning" course.
○ Supervised MS projects related to deep learning.

North Star Developer's Village **Lalitpur, Nepal**
Engineering Manager *Apr 2019 – May 2023*
○ ML face verification; pose-based exam cheating prevention; image/audio annotation; ML training platform.
○ Semantic essay ranking; feedback bot; topic modelling/analysis; ML models exposed via APIs.

Leapfrog Technology **Kathmandu, Nepal**
AI Intern *Oct 2018 – Mar 2019*
○ Predictive models for time-series weather and pollution forecasting (ARIMA and windowing-based).
○ Model deployment and web-based interactive interface.

Department of Electronics & Computer Engineering (DOECE) **Lalitpur, Nepal**
Student Research Assistant for UGC Research Grant Project *Jan 2018 – Sep 2018*
○ Assisted Prof. Dr. Nanda Bikram Adhikari on algorithm/tool research & implementation.
○ Sensor data storage with GPS traces & data mining. Used RNN, RapidMiner, Hadoop, WebSocket, etc.

Education

Oslo Metropolitan University (OsloMet) **Oslo, Norway**
Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.), at the Faculty of Technology, Art and Design (TKD) *May 2023 – Jul 2026*
Thesis submitted July 2026; defense pending.

Thesis: Align–Reason–Trust: Multimodal AI for Reliable Domain Understanding.

Coursework: Topics in AI and ML; Scientific Research Methods and Data Analysis in Engineering Science; Engineering Science and Ethics; Communicating Scientific Research (Simula Academy); Neural Methods in NLP (University of Oslo).

Research Interests: Multimodal AI; Vision–Language Models; Efficient Model Fine-Tuning; Uncertainty Quantification.

Thapathali Campus, Tribhuvan University **Kathmandu, Nepal**
Master's Degree in Informatics & Intelligent Systems Engineering *Oct 2020 – Oct 2022*
Full Scholarship for Academic Merit, Top of Class

Relevant coursework: Natural Language Processing; Computer Vision; Applied Machine Learning; Deep Learning; Computational Intelligence; Information Theory; Information Visualization; Optimization.

Pulchowk Campus, Tribhuvan University **Lalitpur, Nepal**
Bachelor's Degree in Computer Engineering *Oct 2015 – Oct 2019*
Full Scholarship for Academic Merit

Relevant coursework: Artificial Intelligence; Probability & Statistics; Data Mining; Big Data; Theory of Computation.

Technical Capabilities

Programming: Python, Android (Java/Kotlin), SQL, Bash, C/C++.

Libraries and tools: ML/DL, data analysis, numerical computing, visualization, web-frameworks, containerization, cloud, and backend-infrastructure ecosystems (including PyTorch, TensorFlow/Keras, NumPy/SciPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn, Matplotlib, OpenCV, Django, FastAPI, HuggingFace, LangChain, vLLM, PEFT/LoRA, Gradio, Streamlit, Git, Docker, Jupyter, etc.).

AI Safety & Security: Guardrails frameworks (NeMo Guardrails), LLM red-teaming and adversarial robustness testing, jailbreak/prompt-injection defense, safety evaluation and benchmarking.

Languages: English (Fluent), Nepali (Native), Hindi (Advanced), Norwegian (A2).

Academic Projects

MS Thesis: [AI-Based Soccer Game Summarization: From Video Highlights to Dynamic Text Summaries](#).

Best thesis in the department (by scores). In collaboration with the Department of Holistic Systems, **SimulaMet**.

MS Project: [Deep Learning-based Pose Estimation for Dystonia Score Prediction](#). In collaboration with **NAAMII**.

Bachelor's Thesis: [Assessment of Spatiotemporal Weather and Pollution Proxies with RNN and ARIMA](#).

Best Project Award by Department.

Bachelor's Project: [Human Facial Landmarks Detection using Multi-Layer Perceptron](#).

Selected Publications

2025: [Kvasir-VQA-x1: A Multimodal Dataset for Medical Reasoning and Robust MedVQA in Gastrointestinal Endoscopy](#). *MICCAI Workshop on Data Engineering in Medical Imaging*. LNCS, Springer.

2024: [Kvasir-VQA: A Text-Image Pair GI Tract Dataset](#). *VLM4Bio*, ACM Multimedia.

2024: [SoccerNet-Echoes: A Soccer Game Audio Commentary Dataset](#). *IEEE International Symposium on Multimedia*

2023: [Bridging Multimedia Modalities: Enhanced Multimodal AI Understanding and Intelligent Agents](#). *ICMI*, ACM.

2022: [Soccer Game Summarization using Audio Commentary, Metadata, and Captions](#). *Workshop on User-centric Narrative Summarization of Long Videos (NarSUM)*, ACM Multimedia. (Part of master's thesis work)

Awards & Certifications

NAAMII AI Winter School: [Full scholarship for participation](#). Topics: Deep Learning; Computer Vision; Statistics & Algorithms; Data Science; Optimization.

Hult Prize TU Winner (2017): [Winning team "AEGIS"](#). Presented a sustainable idea to empower refugees in Nepal using an e-commerce platform; presented at Hult Business School, Dubai.

Mentor: Global Venture Bootcamp, Asian Development Bank, Philippines — enhancing social ventures with emerging technologies.

Participant: IEEE AI & Big Data Workshop 2018; led multiple IEEE Student Chapter activities on campus.

Participant: UNICEF 1000 Golden Hours Code Camp (2017) — Best Prototype Award for mobile app idea.

References

Dr. Michael Riegler: Head, Department of AI Safety, SimulaMet, Norway
michael@simula.no; +47 401 06 386.

Prof. Pål Halvorsen: Chief Research Scientist, SimulaMet; Professor, OsloMet; Adjunct Professor, UiO, Norway
paalh@simula.uio.no / paalh@ifi.uio.no; +47 970 80 007.

Dr. Vajira Thambawita: Senior Research Scientist, Department of Holistic Systems (HOST), SimulaMet, Norway.
vajira@simula.no; +47 908 06 683.